

## Mark Questions and Answers

### 1. The Gift of the Magi – O. Henry

- Q. Who are the main characters in the story?

The main characters are Jim and Della Young, a loving married couple. They are devoted to each other and willing to make sacrifices to make one another happy.

- Q. What did Della sell to buy Jim's gift?

Della sold her long, beautiful hair to buy a platinum chain for Jim's watch. She did this as an act of love and selflessness, showing how much she cared for him.

- Q. What did Jim sell to buy Della's gift?

Jim sold his gold watch, which was his most treasured possession, to buy a set of combs for Della's hair. This sacrifice shows his deep love and thoughtfulness.

- Q. What is the main theme of the story?

The story highlights love, sacrifice, and the true spirit of giving. It teaches that the value of a gift lies in the thought and love behind it, not in its price.

- Q. Why are Jim and Della called the Magi?

They are called the Magi because they gave gifts out of pure love and wisdom. Like the wise men in the Bible, their sacrifices show true understanding and devotion.

- Q. What were the two possessions the Youngs had?

Jim and Della had two prized possessions — Jim's gold watch, which was a family heirloom, and Della's long, beautiful hair. Both symbolized their pride and love for each other, showing how little they had yet valued what was most meaningful to them.

- Q. Mention the motive behind Jim selling his watch.

Jim sold his watch to buy a set of beautiful combs for Della's hair. His motive was love and the desire to make her happy, showing his willingness to sacrifice his most valuable belonging for her joy.

- Q. How did Jim show his love for Della?

Jim showed his love by sacrificing his gold watch to buy Della a gift. His act of selflessness and understanding reflects true love, proving that emotional connection is more valuable than material possessions.

- Q. Discuss and predict what would have happened if Jim got angry about Della cutting her beautiful hair.

If Jim had become angry, it would have hurt Della deeply and spoiled the meaning of their sacrifice. But his calm reaction and love showed maturity, proving that understanding is more important than appearance or gifts.

## 2. The Brook – Alfred Lord Tennyson

- Q. Who is the speaker in the poem?

The speaker of the poem is the brook itself. It narrates its journey through nature, describing its flow, sounds, and experiences with a lively and joyful tone.

- Q. What does the brook symbolize?

The brook symbolizes the continuous and eternal flow of life. While humans live short lives, the brook represents nature's everlasting movement and resilience.

- Q. Explain the line "Men may come and men may go, but I go on forever."

This line emphasizes the temporary nature of human life compared to the eternity of nature. The brook continues flowing, showing that life and nature move on endlessly.

- Q. Where does the brook end its journey?

The brook ends its journey by joining the brimming river. This shows the completion of its path and symbolizes the continuity of life and nature.

- Q. How does the poet personify the brook?

The poet gives the brook human qualities like talking, playing, and feeling joy. It chatters, babbles, and interacts with the surroundings as if it has emotions.

- Q. Criticize the thought of the brook that states "Men may come and men may go, but I go on forever." Is this statement true?

Yes, the statement is true. It reflects the eternal flow of nature compared to the temporary life of humans. While people live and die, nature continues its course, symbolizing continuity and immortality.

- Q. Is the brook happy or sad? Defend your answer based on the poem.

The brook appears happy and lively. It "chatters," "babbles," and moves playfully through valleys and fields, showing joy and enthusiasm in its journey despite symbolizing life's continuous passage.

## 3. Elon Musk (Biography / Success Story)

- Q. When and where was Elon Musk born?

Elon Musk was born on June 28, 1971, in Pretoria, South Africa. His early interest in technology and innovation set the foundation for his future ventures.

- Q. What was Musk's first company and its purpose?

Musk's first company was Zip2 Corporation, founded in 1995 with his brother Kimbal. It provided online city guides and maps to newspapers and helped him gain early financial success.

- Q. What is the goal of SpaceX?

SpaceX aims to reduce the cost of space travel and make human life multi-planetary. Musk's vision is to colonize Mars and expand humanity beyond Earth.

- Q. What does Tesla aim to achieve?

Tesla aims to promote sustainable energy by producing electric vehicles and solar products. The company is a symbol of innovation and environmental responsibility.

- Q. What qualities make Elon Musk successful?

Elon Musk's strengths include innovation, risk-taking, perseverance, and visionary leadership. These qualities help him achieve ambitious goals despite challenges.

- Q. Write about 'Zip2', the first venture of Musk.

Zip2 was Elon Musk's first company, co-founded with his brother Kimbal in 1995. It provided online city guide software for newspapers and was later sold to Compaq for nearly \$300 million, giving Musk his first major success.

- Q. Summarize the success story of 'TESLA'.

Tesla, founded by Elon Musk and others, revolutionized the automobile industry with electric cars. Its focus on sustainability, innovation, and advanced technology helped make electric vehicles popular worldwide, marking a major step toward green energy.